

General Manual for Accreditation



National Board of Accreditation
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General Manual for Accreditation 2026



**National Board of Accreditation
New Delhi**

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Vision

To be an accrediting agency of international standard by ensuring the highest degree of credibility in assurance of quality and relevance to professional education and come up to the expectations of its stakeholder's viz., academicians, corporates, educational institutions, government, industry, regulators, students and their parents.



Mission

To stimulate the quality of teaching, self-evaluation and accountability in the higher education system, which help institutions realize their academic objectives and adopt teaching practices that enable them to produce high-quality professionals and to assess and accredit the programs offered by the institutions imparting technical and professional education.

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List of Abbreviations

S.N.	Abbreviation	Expansion of abbreviation
1.	AC	Appellate Committee
2.	AAC	Academic Advisory Committee
3.	AICTE	All India Council for Technical Education
4.	CoA	Council of Architecture
5.	COs	Course Outcomes
6.	DCS	Data Capturing Points System
7.	EAC	Evaluation and Accreditation Committee
8.	EC	Executive Committee of NBA
9.	GAPC	Graduate Attributes and Professional Competencies
10.	GC	General Council of NBA
11.	IEA	International Engineering Alliance
12.	MoE	Ministry of Education
13.	MoA	Memorandum of Association
14.	NBA	National Board of Accreditation
15.	OBE	Outcome-Based Education
16.	PCI	Pharmacy Council of India
17.	PEOs	Program Educational Objectives
18.	PG	Postgraduate
19.	POs	Program Outcomes
20.	PQ	Pre-Qualifiers
21.	PSOs	Program Specific Outcomes
22.	SAR	Self - Assessment Report
23.	SCAAC	Sub-Committee of Academic Advisory Committee
24.	UG	Undergraduate
25.	WA	Washington Accord
26.	WK	Knowledge and Attitude Profile

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PART - I

Introduction

1. Introduction

1.1.Preamble

India has a large, complex, and multilayered system of technical and higher education. It has the third-largest higher education system in the world, after China and the United States, comprising 1,168 universities, 45,473 colleges, 12,002 standalone institutions, 4,33,00,000 students including 3,41,70,000 Undergraduates, 52,40,000 Postgraduates, 2,12,000 research scholars, 15,98,000 teaching faculty members (Approximately 56.6% Male and Approximately 43.4% female) and gross enrolment ratio is 28.4 in the year 2021-22 (<https://aishe.gov.in>). Total student enrolment increased from about 3.42 crore in 2014-15 to 4.33 crore in 2021-22 (≈ 26.5 % growth). There are various types of institutions in India, such as Central Government-funded, Institutions of National Importance, State Government-funded, semi-Government-funded, privately funded institutions, and Deemed-to-be Universities.

1.2.About National Board of Accreditation (NBA)

The National Board of Accreditation (NBA) was set-up in September 1994 by the All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE) to assess the qualitative competence of the programs offered by technical educational institutions, ranging from diploma level to postgraduate level, in engineering and technology (diploma, UG and PG), pharmacy (diploma, UG and PG), management (PG), architecture (UG and PG) and related disciplines, which are approved by AICTE and other regulatory bodies.

NBA came into existence as an independent autonomous body with effect from 7 January 2010, with the objective of assuring quality and relevance in technical education, especially for programs in technical disciplines such as Engineering and Technology, Management, Architecture, Pharmacy, Hospitality, etc., through the mechanism of accreditation of programs offered by technical institutions. The Memorandum of Association (MoA) and Rules of NBA were amended in April 2013 to make it completely independent of AICTE, administratively as well as financially. NBA conducts evaluation of programs of technical institutions based on the evaluation criteria and parameters laid down by its Committees and Council. This evaluation may include, but is not limited to, Outcome-Based Curriculum, Outcome-Based Teaching-Learning, Outcome-Based Assessment, Students' Performance, Faculty Information, Faculty Contributions, Facilities and Technical Support, Continuous Improvement, Student Support, Governance, and any other aspects as decided by the Competent Authority of NBA, which help to ensure that graduates produced by the institutions meet industry requirements.

1.3. Objectives of NBA

Major objectives of the NBA are as follows:

- ❖ To assess and accredit technical education programs like Engineering, Management, Pharmacy, Computer Applications, Hotel Management and catering technology, Architecture, etc.;
- ❖ To evolve evaluation criteria and parameters for assessment and accreditation in line with those laid down by the appropriate statutory regulatory authorities for coordination, determination, and regulation of standards in the concerned fields of technical education;
- ❖ To promote excellence through a benchmarking process, which helps determine whether an institution is able to achieve its mission and broad-based goals, and to interpret the results of the outcomes assessment process;
- ❖ To promote a quality-conscious system of technical education in which excellence, relevance to market needs, and participation by all stakeholders are the primary determinants;
- ❖ To build a technical education system that facilitates human resources, aligned with national goals of growth through competence, contribution to the economy through competitiveness, and compatibility with societal development;
- ❖ To set quality benchmarks aimed at strengthening the global and national pool of human capital in all fields of technical education;
- ❖ To conduct evaluation of the self-assessment of technical institutions and/or the programs offered by them, based on guidelines, norms, and standards specified by the NBA; and
- ❖ To contribute to the domain of knowledge related to quality parameters, assessment, and evaluation.

1.4. Authorities and Committees of NBA

The NBA is empowered by its MoA. The governance of NBA is effected through the following three statutory committees enshrined in its MoA:

- (i) The General Council (GC)
- (ii) The Executive Committee (EC)
- (iii) The Academic Advisory Committee (AAC)

All these committees are chaired by the Chairman, NBA.

Member Secretary is the Member Secretary of these committees. Member Secretary is the Executive Authority of NBA.

1.4.1. The General Council

The General Council (GC) is the principal authority of the NBA and is responsible for its overall activities and affairs. It provides policy directions and guidelines to the Executive Committee, which undertakes appropriate measures to manage the activities and affairs of the NBA accordingly. The constitution of the GC is given in the MoA, available on the NBA website.

1.4.2. The Executive Committee

The affairs of the NBA are managed, administered, directed, and controlled in accordance with the rules and bye-laws approved by the Executive Committee (EC) and ratified by the GC. The constitution of the EC is given in the MoA, available on the NBA website.

1.4.3. The Academic Advisory Committee

The Academic Advisory Committee (AAC) of the NBA monitors and promotes the activities of the NBA with reference to its various functions, such as assessment, accreditation, publications, selection and shaping of instruments for assessment and accreditation, operational modalities, and the Rules, Regulations, and Guidelines.

The Chairperson of the Executive Committee is also the Chairperson of the Academic Advisory Committee. The Member Secretary of the NBA is an ex-officio member of the Academic Advisory Committee.

The constitution of the Academic Advisory Committee (AAC) is given in the MoA and available on the NBA website.

1.4.4. Sub-Committees of Academic Advisory Committee (AAC)

Sub-committees for each discipline, namely Engineering and Technology, Management, Pharmacy, Architecture, etc., function separately to evolve standards for assessment and accreditation in their respective fields; to constitute visiting team; to lay down guidelines for chairperson, program evaluators; and to evaluate and approve the recommendations of the Evaluation and Accreditation Committee (EAC).

The Sub-committees also perform such other functions and duties as may be assigned to them by the General Council and/or the Executive Council.

1.4.5. Evaluation and Accreditation Committee

The Evaluation and Accreditation Committee (EAC) is constituted for each discipline, namely Engineering and Technology, Management, Pharmacy, Architecture, etc., to review the reports of the visiting team and to submit its recommendations on accreditation to the

concerned Sub-committee of the Academic Advisory Committee (AAC).

1.4.6. Appellate Committee

The Appellate Committee considers the appeal applications made by the institutions against the decision on accreditation of a program by NBA and gives its recommendations to the Academic Advisory Committee (AAC) for the consideration and disposal of the appeals received.

1.5. Washington Accord

The Washington Accord (WA) is an international, multilateral agreement among bodies responsible for accrediting undergraduate (UG) engineering degree programs. It was originally signed by six countries in 1989. The WA recognizes the substantial equivalence of programs accredited by its signatory bodies and recommends that graduates of programs accredited by any of the signatories be mutually recognized as having met the academic requirements for entry into the practice of engineering within their respective jurisdictions.

The NBA became a provisional member of the WA in 2007 and was granted permanent signatory status on 13 June 2014, which was further extended for six years in June 2020. This signatory status is subject to the condition that only programs of Tier - I institutions accredited by the NBA are eligible for mutual recognition under the WA. The permanent signatory status of WA was granted extension after review for six more years in June, 2020.

1.6. Accreditation

Accreditation is the formal recognition of the quality of an educational program by an external, independent agency through an impartial assessment based on well-defined criteria. It is a process of quality assurance and improvement whereby a program in an approved institution is critically appraised to verify that it continues to meet and/or exceed the standards prescribed by the accrediting body from time to time.

Accreditation provides quality assurance that the academic aims and objectives of an institution are honestly pursued and effectively achieved using the resources currently available, and that the institution has demonstrated the capability to ensure the effectiveness of its educational program(s) over the validity period of accreditation.

Accreditation may be summarized as a process, based on professional judgment, for evaluating whether an educational institution or program meets specified standards of educational quality. Its primary purpose is to assure prospective students and other

stakeholders that graduates of an institution offering accredited programs have achieved at least a minimum level of competence in their chosen fields of study.

1.7. Outcome-Based Education (OBE) and Accreditation

Outcome-Based Education (OBE) focuses on achieving clearly defined outcomes—encompassing knowledge, skills, attitudes, and behaviour—by the end of an academic program. Teaching and learning activities designed with this focus, along with systematic efforts to assess and measure attainment, constitute OBE. This approach involves a structured methodology to evaluate the achievement of outcomes and to benchmark them against the POs, in alignment with the stated objectives of the program.

Initially, NBA accreditation followed the Input–Process–Output model, with primary emphasis on the availability of resources and facilities and the outputs derived from them. In 2009, NBA aligned its accreditation framework with international best practices and transitioned to an outcome-based accreditation system. This shift was based on the premise that educational quality is better reflected through outcomes rather than inputs alone, as inputs do not necessarily guarantee quality outcomes. Outcomes are influenced not only by inputs but also by the effectiveness of institutional processes that transform inputs into clearly defined outcomes.

1.8. Purpose of Accreditation

The purpose of accreditation by the NBA is to promote and recognize excellence in technical education in colleges and universities—at both the undergraduate and postgraduate levels. Institutions, students, employers, and the public at large all benefit from the external verification of quality provided through the NBA accreditation process. They also benefit from the process of continuous quality improvement encouraged by the NBA’s developmental approach in promoting excellence in technical education.

Through accreditation, the following main purposes are served:

- ❖ Support and advise technical institutions in the maintenance and enhancement of their quality;
- ❖ Provide confidence and assurance of quality to various stakeholders, including students;
- ❖ Assure the good standing of an institution to government departments and other interested bodies; and
- ❖ Enable institution to state publicly that it has voluntarily accepted assessment of its systems and processes by the NBA and has satisfied all the requirements for operating and maintaining quality in education.

1.9. Benefits of Accreditation

The process of accreditation helps in realizing a number of benefits, such as:

- ❖ Helps the institution to identify its strengths, weaknesses, and opportunities;
- ❖ Introduces institutions to innovative and modern methods of pedagogy;
- ❖ Gives institutions a renewed sense of direction and identity;
- ❖ Provides society with reliable information on the quality of education offered;
- ❖ Assures students studying in NBA-accredited programs that they will receive education of high academic quality and professional relevance, with the needs of the corporate world integrated into the programs, activities, and processes;
- ❖ Assures prospective employers that students come from a program where the content and quality have been evaluated against established standards, and that graduates have acquired competence based on well-established technical inputs; and
- ❖ Helps in gaining the confidence of stakeholders and sends a strong message that our technical manpower meets international standards, thereby enhancing global mobility.

1.10. Impact of Accreditation

The impact of accreditation goes far beyond quality assurance of an institution/program.

The major impacts of the accreditation system are summarized below:

- ❖ Encourages quality improvement initiatives by institutions;
- ❖ Improves student enrolment both in terms of quality and quantity;
- ❖ Helps institutions secure necessary funds;
- ❖ Enhances the employability of graduates;
- ❖ Facilitates transnational recognition of degrees and mobility of graduates and professionals;
- ❖ Motivates faculty to participate actively in academic and related institutional/departmental activities;
- ❖ Helps create a sound and challenging academic environment in the institution; and
- ❖ Contributes to the social and economic development of the country by producing high-quality technical manpower.

1.11. Imperatives of Accreditation

Accreditation of educational institutions/programs is a global practice, and its need has been felt by various developing and developed countries for one or more of the following purposes:

- ❖ Funding decisions;
- ❖ State recognition of qualifications/certification of professionals;
- ❖ Accountability of institutions to stakeholders;

- ❖ Encouraging self-improvement initiatives by institutions; and
- ❖ Quality assurance of educational programs.

PART – II

Accreditation Policy

2. Accreditation Policy

2.1.Scope

The NBA accords accreditation to the programs listed in Table No.1 under the following professional discipline:

Table No. 1: List of levels of professional programs accredited by NBA.

S.N.	Programs/Disciplines	Level (Diploma/UG/PG)
1	Engineering and Technology	Diploma, UG, PG
2	Management	PG
3	Pharmacy	Diploma, UG, PG
4	Architecture	UG, PG
5	Computer Applications	PG
6	Hotel Management and Catering Technology	UG

2.2.Policy on Classification of Institutions for UG Engineering Programs

Presently, NBA operates on a two-Tier system for UG Engineering Programs only. For all other programs, the operation is uniform for all institutions. The classification in respect of UG Engineering Programs has been retained since WA recognizes the substantial equivalency of UG Engineering qualifications accorded by different member countries. Only the UG Engineering Programs offered by Tier - I institutions which are accredited by NBA fall under the ambit of WA.

2.2.1.TIER - I Institutions

The categories of institutions that qualify for Tier - I accreditation for UG Engineering/Technology programs through NBA are given below:

- ❖ Institutions of National Importance (Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs), Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Indian Institutes of Information Technology (IIITs), etc.).
- ❖ National Institutes of Technology (NITs).
- ❖ Central Universities (universities established by or under an Act enacted by the Parliament of India).
- ❖ State Universities (universities established by or under legislation enacted by the legislature of the concerned States).
- ❖ Private Universities (universities established by or under legislation enacted by the State Legislature but promoted by private trusts, societies, or companies under Section 25 of the Indian Companies Act).

- ❖ Deemed-to-be Universities (institutions declared as Deemed-to-be Universities by MoE.
- ❖ Institutions declared autonomous by a competent empowered authority.

These institutions have the freedom to design, develop, and update curricula and also have complete academic autonomy.

2.2.2. TIER - II Institutions

Tier - II accreditation for UG Engineering/Technology programs is applicable to non-autonomous institutions affiliated with a university. These institutions depend on the University for any change in the curriculum, its implementation, and the examination of enrolled students for the award of degrees.

Tier II includes Undergraduate Engineering / Technology Programs offered by Government Colleges, Government Aided Colleges, Private/Self Financing Colleges.

2.3. General Policy on Accreditation

The following general policies are the guiding principles for accreditation of programs offered by various technical institutions:

- i) NBA accredits programs of technical institutions (as per its scope mentioned in Section 2.1) and not the institutions as a whole, which is in conformity with internationally accepted practice.
- ii) Institutions are required to apply for accreditation through the e-NBA portal as per the norms prescribed by NBA from time-to-time.
- iii) Programs to be accredited should be offered by an educational institution that has been formally approved by the AICTE or the concerned regulatory authority.
- iv) Except for Management programs, all other programs from which at least two batches of students have graduated are considered for accreditation.
- v) In case an Institution is conferred autonomous status for the first time by a competent authority from the particular Academic Year, it can apply only in Tier - I from 1st July onwards of the fourth Academic Year. It can apply in Tier - II in the interim period, if it wishes so. The program should have been running continuously without any break, with the approval of the concerned regulatory authority, during the entire duration of the last two batches (for example, 5 years for UG Engineering programs and 3 years for PG Engineering programs, etc.). For Management programs, those from which at least three batches of students have graduated are considered for accreditation.
- vi) Engineering programs offered by affiliated institutions (autonomous (Tier - I)/ non-

autonomous (Tier - II) shall have uninterrupted affiliation with the concerned affiliating university, with no break in admissions during the entire duration of the last two batches (for example, 5 years for UG Engineering programs and 3 years for PG Engineering programs, etc.).

- vii) For consideration of accreditation of a PG Engineering or a PG Pharmacy program, it is mandatory that the corresponding UG Engineering or UG Pharmacy program has valid accreditation on the date of application. However, this requirement shall not apply to special PG Engineering or PG Pharmacy programs that do not have a corresponding UG Engineering or UG Pharmacy program running in the institution. Such special PG Engineering or PG Pharmacy programs will be considered on a case-by-case basis.
- viii) Considering accreditation by the NBA for Dual Country Collaboration and Twinning/Joint Degree/Dual Degree Programs offered by an Indian institution through collaborative/twinning mode with a foreign university/institution, the following process shall be followed for evaluation of the program:
 - a. If the foreign country is a signatory to the Washington Accord, then the program/institution in that foreign country should have accreditation from the approved accrediting agency of that signatory member country. Further, the program should hold valid current accreditation status at the time of NBA accreditation.
 - b. If the foreign country is not a signatory to the Washington Accord, then the program offered by the collaborating partner institution/university of the foreign country should have accreditation from an approved local accrediting agency of that country or from accrediting agency of any other signatory member country of the Washington Accord. Further, the program should hold valid current accreditation status at the time of NBA accreditation.
- ix) For the Dual country programs in Management offered by an Indian Institution in collaboration with a foreign University/Institution, the Indian Institution should ensure that the collaborating partner Institution of the foreign country has accreditation from at least 2 out of the following 3 accreditation agencies:
 - a. The Association of MBAs (AMBA)
 - b. EFMD Quality Improvement System (EQUIS)
 - c. Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business (AACSB)
- x) The institution is required to pay the accreditation fee as prescribed by NBA from time to time. The accreditation fee is payable in two phases: 10 per cent as the first-phase fee at the time of submission of Pre-Qualifiers (PQ), and the remaining 90 per cent as the second- phase fee at the time of submission of the SAR, after the PQs are

approved.

- xi) The institution must submit the Self-Assessment Report (SAR) online through the e-NBA portal in the prescribed format for each program applied for accreditation.
- xii) The institution must upload the DCS report in case of UG Engineering programs, generated after SAR submission, to its official website and provide the corresponding link in the e-NBA profile of the institution.
- xiii) The title of the program to be accredited must be exactly the same as that shown on the graduating student's degree and in the approval letters of the concerned regulatory authority.
- xiv) Part-time programs are not considered for accreditation.
- xv) Programs are evaluated in accordance with the accreditation criteria as specified by NBA from time-to-time.
- xvi) Institutions are required to represent the accreditation status of each program accurately and without ambiguity. If accreditation is withdrawn or discontinued or has expired, the institution shall no longer refer to the program as accredited.
- xvii) A three-day on-site visit is a part of the accreditation process. A visiting team, appointed by NBA, carries out the evaluation of the program. The institution is required to propose five suitable sets of dates (not more than two sets in a month) for the visit, during which regular classes and all academic activities of the program applied for are in progress.
- xviii) Institutions have the option to withdraw a program during the exit meeting of the visit. The institution shall hand over a written request to the visiting chairperson during the exit meeting. No communication regarding withdrawal will be accepted after the visiting team has left the institution. No fee shall be refunded in such cases.
- xix) The final decision taken by NBA is communicated to the educational institution, along with comments detailing the strengths, weaknesses, and scope for improvement.
- xx) A copy of the visiting team's report is sent to the institution along with the accreditation status to maintain transparency. In the event of revision of the recommendations of the Visiting Team by the decision-making committee, the reasons for changes are also conveyed along with the Visiting Team report.
- xxi) Commencement of the accreditation period:
 - ❖ The period of accreditation will commence from 1st January of a calendar Year. The Calendar Year will be decided on the basis of the Current Academic Year (CAY) considered for evaluation of a program. For example, in case of CAY 2025-26 is considered the commencement of accreditation of a program will from 1st January 2026 onwards either for 3 or 6 calendar years.

- ❖ The same rules shall apply for determining the commencement and validity period of accreditation for programs in appeal cases as well.
- xxii) If an institution requests postponement of the visit of the Expert Team after the team has already been constituted for the purpose, an additional fee of 25% shall be required to be paid before the visit is rescheduled. If the institution causes cancellation of the visit after the team has already been constituted for the purpose, there would be a cancellation fee of 25% deducted from the fees paid by the institution. In case, an institution requests for withdrawal of the program(s) applied by it after application has been approved by the NBA for further processing and the fee has been paid by the institution, 10% of the accreditation fee per program shall be deducted while refunding the fee as per the request of the institution.

2.4. Policy on Award of Accreditation

The NBA grants accreditation to any program for a maximum duration of six years, depending on the level of compliance with the prescribed accreditation criteria.

The accreditation duration is one of the following:

- i) Accreditation of the Program for Six years; or
- ii) Accreditation of the Program for Three years; or
- iii) No accreditation of the Program

The duration of accreditation is decided by the competent authority, based on the recommendations of the visiting team and the extent of fulfillment of NBA criteria.

2.5. Appeal Policy

If the institution is not satisfied with the NBA's decision on the Status of Accreditation, then the institution can make an appeal against the decision within 30 days of date of receipt of communication from NBA along with the fee given in Section 6: Fee Structure and Refund Policy. The appeal is placed before the Appellate Committee in which the institutions are invited to present their case before the Committee. The recommendations of Appellate Committee are considered by the Academic Advisory Committee (AAC) for taking decision on appeal.

2.6. Policy on Re-Accreditation of Program

If a program is 'Not Accredited' or is withdrawn during the visit, a fresh application for accreditation of the same program may be considered after one year from the date of previous visit of the visiting team.

Institutions whose UG Engineering programs have already been granted accreditation for a period of three years are required to submit a compliance report at least six months

before the expiry of the validity of accreditation, along with the prescribed compliance fee.

Upon receipt of the Compliance report, NBA constitutes a visiting team of experts to visit the institution for evaluation. The evaluation report submitted by the visiting team is considered by the concerned committee of NBA for continuation of accreditation for an appropriate period.

Programs accredited for 6 years are required to submit the fresh application at least five months prior to the expiry of the program validity to ensure continuity of accreditation.

2.7. Policy for Visiting Team

2.7.1. Base Qualifiers for Visiting Team Chairperson and Program Evaluators

Base qualifiers for the visiting team as program evaluator and chairperson are shown in Table No. 2.

Table No. 2: Base qualifiers for program evaluators and chairpersons.

Institute / Industry	For Program Evaluators		
	Qualifications	Career Profile	Accomplishments
Academic Evaluators/ Research Organizations	Ph.D. preferably in an allied area (for UG & PG programs) M. Tech. or equivalent (for Diploma program)	Associate Professor + 4 plus years' experience or Scientist D and above (Research Organizations)	Minimum two publications in WoS indexed journals
Industry/ Corporates	M. Tech. or B. Tech. with first division or equivalent	15 years' experience in research, design, development, corporate training, quality control, etc.	Demonstrated accomplishments of a high order in an allied area of activity
For Chairpersons			
	All the above conditions	❖ Should be a Professor or ❖ Director of institution of national repute ❖ Should have significant experience in accreditation/program evaluation ❖ Should have administrative experience preferably as Head, Dean or Coordinator of an academic program or ❖ should have ongoing/ completed three R&D or consultancy projects (in previous 5 years)	May have undergone around 10 visits of NBA

2.7.2. Composition of the Visiting Team

NBA's visiting team comprises one chairperson (visiting team chairperson) and two program evaluators for each program. In the case of a Diploma Engineering program, the team may consist of a Chairperson and one Program Evaluator. In such cases, while appointing the chairperson, NBA ensures that the chairperson belongs to the same or an allied program discipline.

The program evaluators are drawn from both serving and retired professionals. NBA provides regular training and orientation to evaluators through workshops and seminars to ensure a smooth and standardized evaluation process. This also helps in updating the program evaluators on the current policies of NBA.

2.7.3. General Policies for Formation of Visiting Team

- i) The chairperson and program evaluators are selected from a State different from the State in which the institution is located.
- ii) There should be no adverse points pending against the evaluator. Adverse points may include:
 - ❖ Non-submission of the report within the stipulated time;
 - ❖ Misrepresentation of information;
 - ❖ Violation of the code of conduct; and
 - ❖ Inputs from vigilance or investigating agencies.
- iii) The visiting team is constituted by NBA after obtaining the consent of the members to undertake the visit on the specified dates.

PART - III

Accreditation Framework

3. Accreditation Framework

3.1. Graduate Attributes and Professional Competencies (GAPC V4.0)

The Graduate Attributes and Professional Competencies (GAPC V4.0) is the revised competency framework for engineering education, which defines the expected knowledge, skills, and professional competencies that graduates must acquire and demonstrate by the time of graduation. The framework is aligned with internationally accepted engineering standards formulated by the International Engineering Alliance (IEA) and endorsed by UNESCO. The GAPC V4.0 is adopted for implementation in NBA accreditation processes to ensure OBE and global comparability of engineering programs.

In 2013, NBA revised the SAR in accordance with GAPC V3.0, incorporating 12 POs. Subsequently, in 2024, the SAR was revised based on GAPC V4.0, incorporating 11 POs, in alignment with the framework of the International Engineering Alliance (IEA).

3.2. Accreditation Criteria

The assessment and evaluation process of accreditation of an engineering program is based on 9 broad criteria developed through a participatory process involving experts from reputed national-level technical institutions, industries, R&D organizations and professional bodies. Each criterion relates to a major feature of institutional activity and its effectiveness. The criteria have been formulated in terms of parameters, including quantitative measurements that have been designed for maximal objective assessment of each feature. The definitions of the terms used in this manual are as follows:

- a. **Mission and Vision Statement** – Mission statements are essentially the means to achieve the vision of the institution. For example, if the vision is to create high-quality engineering professionals, then the mission could be to offer a well-balanced program of instruction, practical experience, and opportunities for overall personality development. Vision is a futuristic statement that the institution would like to achieve over a long period of time, and Mission is the means by which it proposes to move toward the stated Vision.
- b. **Program Educational Objectives (PEOs)** – Program Educational Objectives are broad statements that describe the career and professional accomplishments that the program is preparing graduates to achieve.
- c. **Program Outcomes (POs)** – Program Outcomes are statements that describe what students are expected to know and be able to do upon graduating from the program.

These relate to the skills, knowledge, attitude and behaviour that students acquire through the program. NBA has defined the Program Outcomes for each discipline.

- d. **Course Outcomes (COs)** – Course Outcomes are narrower statements that describe what students are expected to know, and are able to do at the end of each course. These relate to the skills, knowledge and behaviour that students acquire in their progress through the course.
- (e) **Assessment** – Assessment is one or more processes, carried out by the institution, that identify, collect, and prepare data to evaluate the achievement of Program Educational Objectives and Program Outcomes.
- e. **Program Specific Outcomes (PSOs):** Program shall specify 2-4 program specific outcomes, if required. These are the statements, which are specific to the particular program. They are beyond POs. Program Curriculum and other activities during the program must help in the achievement of PSOs along with POs.
- f. **Evaluation** – Evaluation is one or more processes, done by the evaluation team, for interpreting the data and evidence accumulated through assessment practices. Evaluation determines the extent to which Program Educational Objectives or Program Outcomes are being achieved, and results in decisions and actions to improve the program.
- g. **Mapping** – Mapping is the process of representing, preferably in matrix form, the correlation among the parameters. It may be done for one to many, many to one, and many to many parameters.
- h. **Rubrics:** Rubrics provide a powerful tool for assessment and grading of student work. They can also serve as a transparent and inspiring guide to learning. Rubrics are scoring, or grading tool used to measure a students' performance and learning across a set of criteria and objectives. Rubrics communicate to students (and to other markers) your expectations in the assessment, and what you consider important.

3.3. Knowledge and Attitude Profile (WK)

The Knowledge and Attitude Profile (WK) is intended to define the essential knowledge base and professional attitudes expected of program graduates. It ensures alignment with OBE principles and equips graduates with the capability to effectively analyze and address complex engineering problem.

WK1: A systematic, theory-based understanding of the natural sciences applicable to the discipline and awareness of relevant social sciences.

WK2: Conceptually-based mathematics, numerical analysis, data analysis, statistics and formal aspects of computer and information science to support detailed analysis and modelling applicable to the discipline.

WK3: A systematic, theory-based formulation of engineering fundamentals required in the engineering discipline.

WK4: Engineering specialist knowledge that provides theoretical frameworks and bodies of knowledge for the accepted practice areas in the engineering discipline; much is at the forefront of the discipline.

WK5: Knowledge, including efficient resource use, environmental impacts, whole-life cost, reuse of resources, net zero carbon, and similar concepts, that supports engineering design and operations in a practice area.

WK6: Knowledge of engineering practice (technology) in the practice areas in the engineering discipline.

WK7: Knowledge of the role of engineering in society and identified issues in engineering practice in the discipline, such as the professional responsibility of an engineer to public safety and sustainable development.

WK8: Engagement with selected knowledge in the current research literature of the discipline, awareness of the power of critical thinking and creative approaches to evaluate emerging issues.

WK9: Ethics, inclusive behavior and conduct. Knowledge of professional ethics, responsibilities, and norms of engineering practice. Awareness of the need for diversity by reason of ethnicity, gender, age, physical ability etc. with mutual understanding and respect, and of inclusive attitudes.

3.5. Program Outcomes (POs) and Program-Specific Outcomes (PSOs)

The NBA has clearly defined distinct sets of Program Outcomes (POs) for each program across all disciplines. Presented below are illustrative samples of the prescribed POs for Diploma engineering programs, UG Engineering programs, and PG engineering programs, PG management programs.

List of POs for Diploma engineering programs:

PO1: Apply knowledge of mathematics, natural sciences, engineering fundamentals, and an engineering specialization (as specified in DK1 to DK4) to a wide range of practical procedures and practices.

PO2: Identify and analyze well-defined engineering problems and reach substantiated conclusions using codified methods of analysis specific to their field of activity (DK1 to DK4).

PO3: Design solutions for well-defined technical problems and assist in the design of systems, components, or processes to meet specified needs, with appropriate

consideration for public health and safety, as well as cultural, societal, and environmental factors (DK5).

PO4: Conduct investigations of well-defined problems by locating and search relevant codes and catalogues, and by conducting standard tests and measurements (DK8).

PO5: Apply appropriate techniques, resources, and modern computing, engineering and IT tools to well-defined engineering problems, while being aware of their limitations (DK2 and DK6).

PO6: When solving well-defined engineering problems, evaluate sustainable development impacts to: society, the economy, sustainability, health and safety, legal frameworks, and the environment (DK1, DK5, and DK7).

PO7: Understand and commit to professional ethics and the norms of technician practice, including compliance with relevant laws. Demonstrate an understanding of the need for diversity and inclusion (DK9).

PO8: Function effectively as an individual, and as a member or leader in diverse and inclusive teams, in multidisciplinary face-to-face/remote/distributed settings (DK9).

PO9: Communicate effectively and inclusively on well-defined engineering activities with the engineering community and society at large by comprehending the work of others, documenting one's own work, and giving and receiving clear instructions.

PO10: Demonstrate awareness of engineering management principles as a member or leader of a technical team and apply them to manage projects in multidisciplinary environments.

PO11: Recognize the need for, and have the ability for independent updating in the face of specialized technical knowledge (DK8).

Program shall specify up to 3 Program Specific Outcomes

List of POs for UG engineering programs:

PO1: Engineering Knowledge: Apply knowledge of mathematics, natural science, computing, engineering fundamentals and an engineering specialization as specified in WK1 to WK4 respectively to develop to the solution of complex engineering problems.

PO2: Problem Analysis: Identify, formulate, review research literature and analyze complex engineering problems reaching substantiated conclusions with consideration for sustainable development. (WK1 to WK4)

PO3: Design/Development of Solutions: Design creative solutions for complex engineering problems and design/develop systems/components/processes to meet identified needs with consideration for the public health and safety, whole-life cost, net zero carbon, culture, society and environment as required. (WK5)

PO4: Conduct Investigations of Complex Problems: Conduct investigations of complex engineering problems using research-based knowledge including design of experiments, modelling, analysis & interpretation of data to provide valid conclusions. (WK8).

PO5: Engineering Tool Usage: Create, select and apply appropriate techniques, resources and modern engineering & IT tools, including prediction and modelling recognizing their limitations to solve complex engineering problems. (WK2 and WK6).

PO6: The Engineer and The World: Analyze and evaluate societal and environmental aspects while solving complex engineering problems for its impact on sustainability with reference to economy, health, safety, legal framework, culture and environment. (WK1, WK5, and WK7).

PO7: Ethics: Apply ethical principles and commit to professional ethics, human values, diversity and inclusion; adhere to national & international laws. (WK9).

PO8: Individual and Collaborative Team work: Function effectively as an individual, and as a member or leader in diverse/multi-disciplinary teams.

PO9: Communication: Communicate effectively and inclusively within the engineering community and society at large, such as being able to comprehend and write effective reports and design documentation, make effective presentations considering cultural, language, and learning differences.

PO10: Project Management and Finance: Apply knowledge and understanding of engineering management principles and economic decision-making and apply these to one's own work, as a member and leader in a team, and to manage projects and in multidisciplinary environments.

PO11: Life-Long Learning: Recognize the need for, and have the preparation and ability for i) independent and life-long learning ii) adaptability to new and emerging technologies and iii) critical thinking in the broadest context of technological change. (WK8)

Program shall specify up to 2-3 PSOs.

List of POs for PG engineering programs:

PO1: An ability to independently carry out research /investigation and development work to solve practical problems

PO2: An ability to write and present a substantial technical report/document

PO3: Students should be able to demonstrate a degree of mastery over the area as per the specialization of the program. The mastery should be at a level higher than the requirements in the appropriate bachelor program

Program may add up to 3 additional POs.

List of POs for PG Management programs:

PO1: Apply knowledge of management theories and practices to solve business problems.

PO2: Foster Analytical and critical thinking abilities for data-based decision making.

PO3: Ability to develop Value based Leadership ability.

PO4: Ability to understand, analyze and communicate global, economic, legal, and ethical aspects of business.

PO5: Ability to lead themselves and others in the achievement of organizational goals, contributing effectively to a team environment.

Program may add up to 3 additional POs.

3.6. Structure of Accreditation Criteria

The accreditation criteria are structured to ensure a systematic and comprehensive evaluation of academic programs in alignment with OBE principles. In general, the SAR typically comprises a set of clearly defined criteria covering aspects such as program educational objectives, curriculum and teaching-learning processes, student performance and attainment of outcomes, faculty qualifications and adequacy, infrastructure and learning resources, governance and institutional support, and continuous improvement mechanisms.

The number of criteria included in the SAR for each program across all disciplines is clearly specified, and the corresponding program-wise SAR formats for each discipline are made available on the website of the NBA.

PART – IV

Accreditation Process

4.1. Accreditation Stages

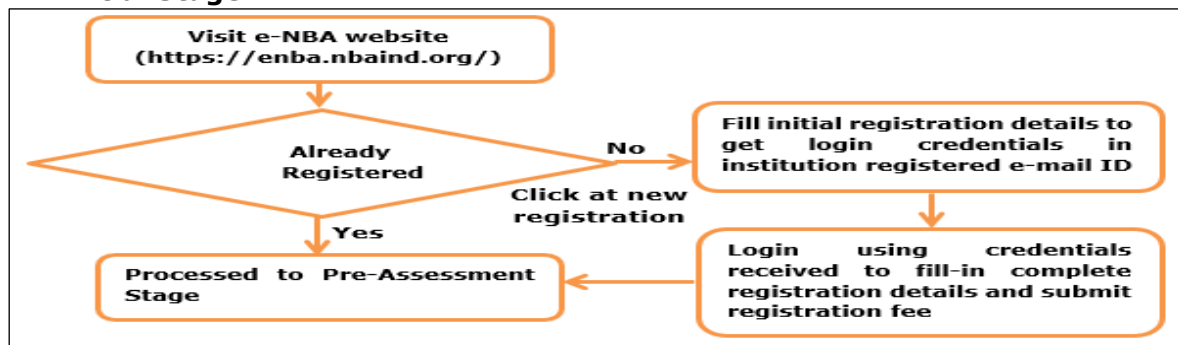
Accreditation workflow for Tier - I/Tier - II Engineering institutions is summarized in the workflow diagram (Figure No.1) and described below.

Eligible institutions may apply for accreditation of their programs online through the Accreditation Workflow Management System (e-NBA) at <https://enba.nbaind.org/>. The accreditation process can be grouped into four sequential stages, essentially in the following order:

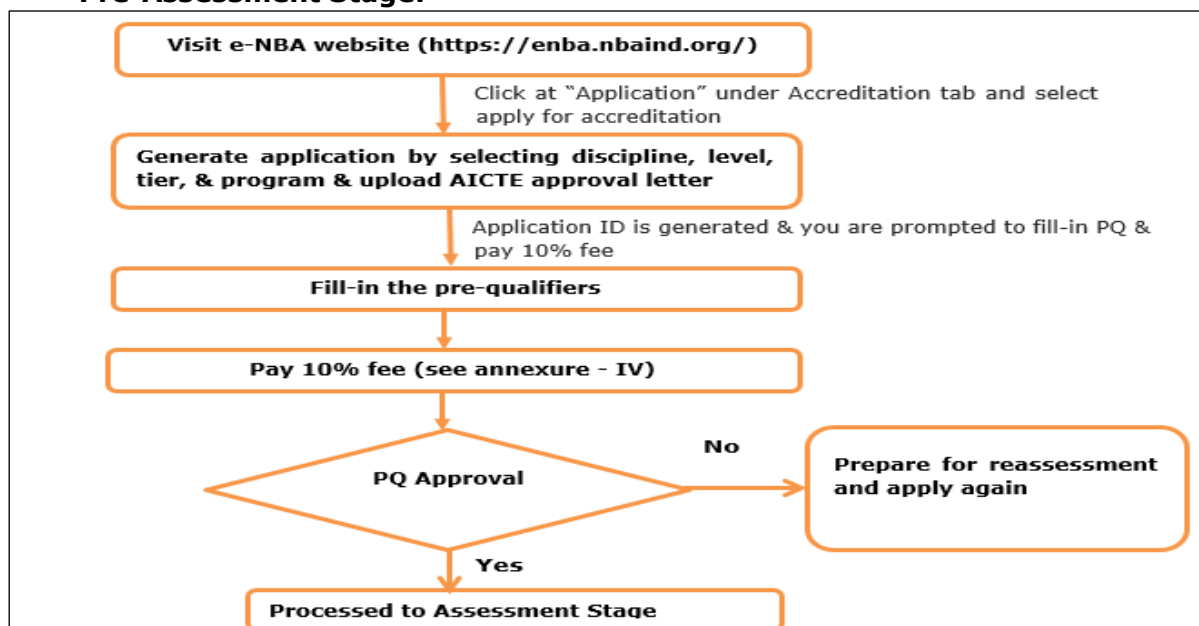
- i) Initial Stage (Registration)
- ii) Pre-Assessment Stage
- iii) Assessment Stage
- iv) Post-Assessment Stage (Decision-Making)

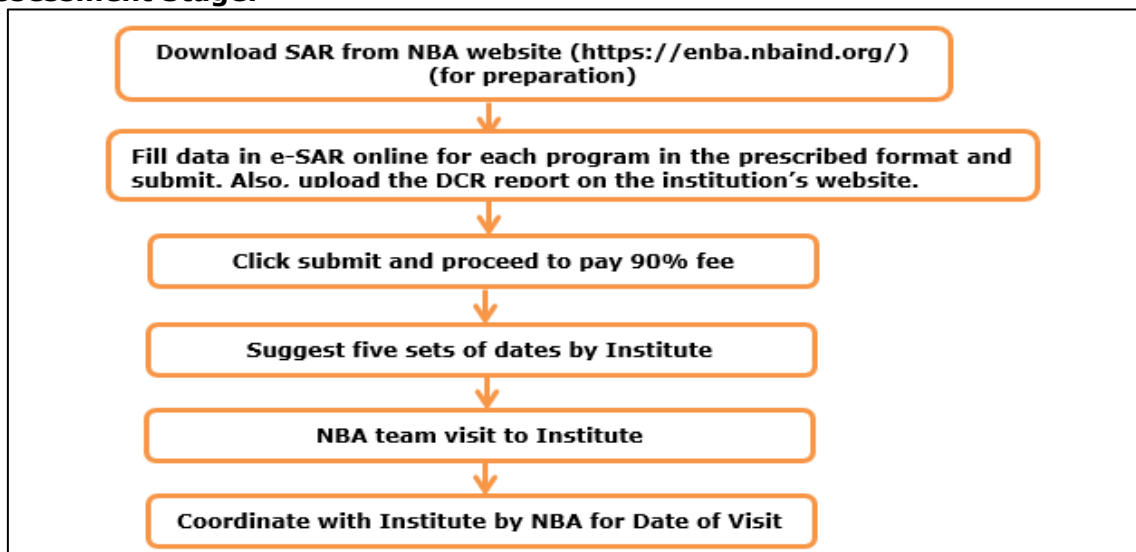
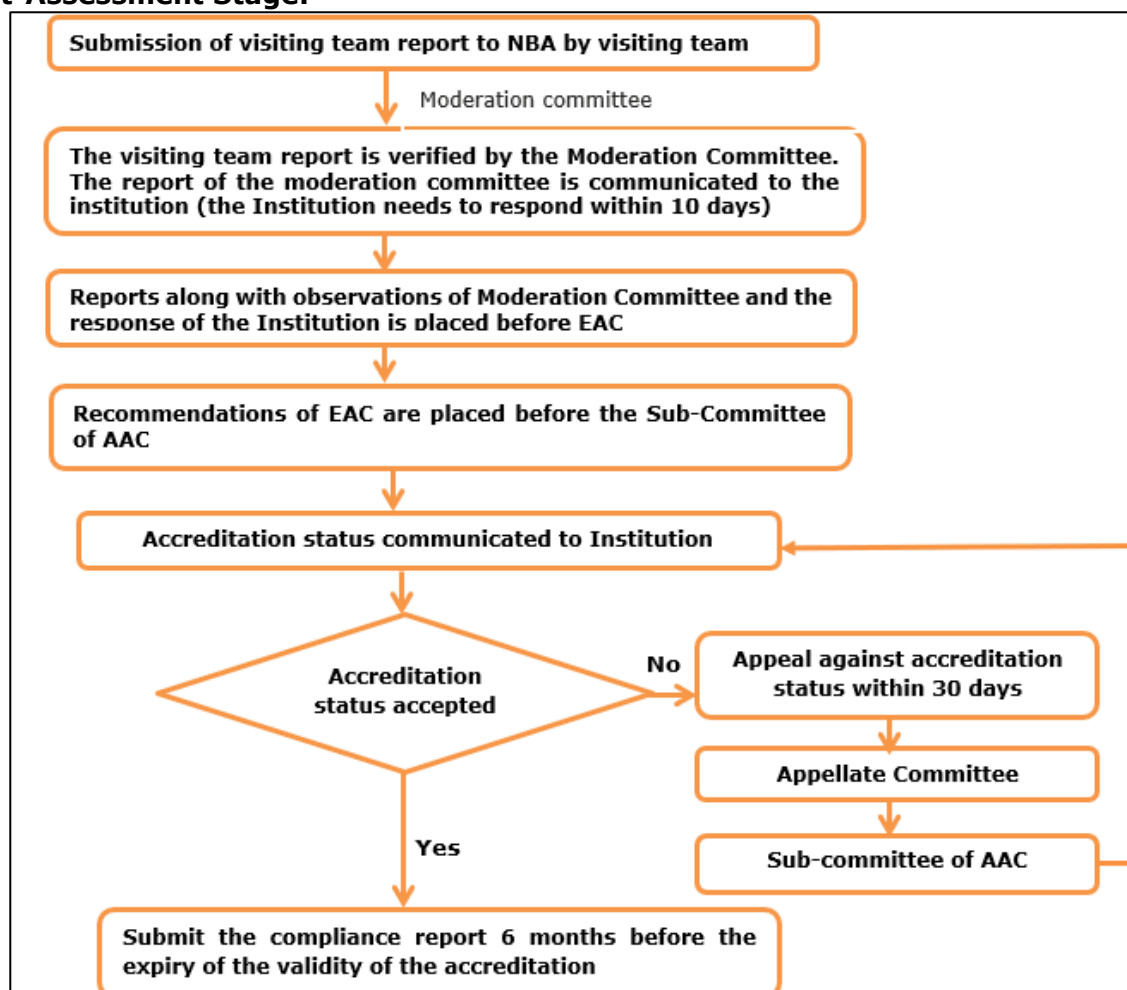
The applicant institution must complete each stage before proceeding to the next stage. In the case of engineering programs and the MCA program, Moderation Committee is applicable.

Initial Stage:



Pre-Assessment Stage:



Assessment Stage:**Post-Assessment Stage:****Figure No. 1:** Accreditation workflow: Assessment stage and post-assessment stage.

4.1.1. Initial Stage (Registration)

Institutions willing to seek accreditation of their programs by NBA are required to register with e-NBA. Registration with e-NBA is a one-time process. Once registered, they can at any time apply for accreditation of their programs. After filing the initial registration form, the user receives a user ID and password to complete the registration process by filling in the full Registration form. Figure No. 2 shows the screenshot of the initial registration and login interface for registered institutions.

Important Notes

- Bank Transaction fee charges would not be refunded/ reversed under any circumstances for any refund/ reversal /chargeback and any other reasons.
- Bank Transaction fees charged would be borne by the concerned institute for any payment.
- Non-refundable fees will not be refunded for any reason as per the NBA policy.

Login

Username

Password

[Forgot Password?](#) [New Registration?](#)

Login Reset

Accredited Programs

- Engineering(UG) Tier I/Tier II
- Engineering(PG /Diploma)
- Management(PG)
- Pharmacy(UG /Diploma)
- MCA
- Architecture
- Hospitality & Tourism Mgmt

Contact Us

National Board of Accreditation
4th floor, East Tower, NBCC Place, Bhisham Pitamah Marg Pragati Vihar, New Delhi 110003, INDIA
For General Query 011 24360620-22

Figure No. 2: Registration of institution on e-NBA.

Steps involved in the process of registration are as follows:

- ❖ The process of registration involves filling in and submitting basic information of the registering institution in the data input boxes on the e-NBA Registration Interface. Upon submission of the basic information, the institution receives temporary login credentials through its registered e-mail, which become the permanent user ID after payment of the one-time Registration Fee (see Annexure I: Fee Structure).
- ❖ The institution is required to log in using the credentials received through its registered e-mail to complete the registration process. This includes entering information in the data input boxes on the e-NBA portal, such as details of the Head of the Institution, key promoters, bank details, and programs proposed for accreditation, and uploading copies of all AICTE approval letters and affiliating University affiliation letters (academic year-wise for last 5 years) or approvals from any other appropriate regulatory authority e.g. Academic Council/Board of Governors in case of Universities, as the case may be. The uploaded copies should be duly authenticated on each page by the Head of the Institution.
- ❖ The institution is required to pay the one-time registration fee to complete the registration process.

- ❖ Institutions already registered with e-NBA are not required to register again.
- ❖ The above-mentioned process should be completed within 15 working days from the initiation of registration, failing which the institution will be required to register again.
- ❖ Institutions already registered with e-NBA are not required to restart the registration process.

4.1.2. Pre-Assessment Stage

4.1.2.1. Application for Accreditation

- ❖ A registered institution may apply online for accreditation of its programs by NBA. The institution shall login to the e-NBA portal using the login credentials obtained during the registration process mentioned above.
- ❖ The appropriate application format gets generated by selecting the Discipline, Level, and Program(s) from the pull-down menus, as shown in Figure No.3.

	Architecture/Engg.& Tech./Pharmacy/HMCT	Management	Computer Application
Discipline	Select Discipline	Select Discipline	Select Discipline
Level	Select Level	Select Level	Select Level
Tier	-Select-	None	-Select-
Format	-Select-		
Programme	Select Programme	Select Programme	Select Programme
	Select Cycle	Select Program Type	
Latest Accreditation	Select Latest Accreditation Stat	Select Latest Accreditation Stat	Select Latest Accreditation Stat
	Add To List	Add To List	Add To List

Figure No. 3: Generating Application(s) for Accreditation of Specific Program.

- ❖ Upload all AICTE Approval Letters for the last five academic years, including the current academic year, or approvals from any other appropriate regulatory authority, duly authenticated by the Head of the Institution.
- ❖ Upload all AICTE Approval Letters and affiliation letters from the affiliating University in case of affiliated Institutions for the last five academic years, including the current academic year, or approvals from any other appropriate regulatory authority e.g. Academic Council/Board of Governors in case of Universities, as the case may be. The uploaded copies should be duly authenticated by the Head of the Institution.
- ❖ Institutions can apply for accreditation of up to five programs through a single application on the e-NBA portal. Management and MCA programs may be clubbed with other programs in a single application. Applications for accreditation may be submitted

at any time when the institution is reasonably confident that its programs comply with the relevant PQs and that systems for OBE and accreditation have been established and well imbibed by the faculty members of the program.

- ❖ Click the “Submit” button to submit the application to NBA for further processing.
- ❖ An Application ID is generated upon successful submission of the application.

4.1.2.2. Submission of Pre-Qualifiers

After the generation of the application, the institution is required to fill-in the PQ for the program(s) to be accredited through the e-NBA portal. Log-in to the e-NBA portal and click on “Pre-Qualifiers / e-SAR” under “Application” from the left navigation panel. The e-NBA portal will display the Application Number, Program, and Level. Click on “Proceed to Pre-Qualifiers.”

The e-NBA portal seeks information related to the PQ. A screenshot of the Sample Page of Pre-Qualifiers (PQS) is provided below as an example in Figure No. 4.

Prequalifier

Application ID: 11539 | Discipline: Engineering & Technology | Program Name: Computer Science and Engineering | Level: Under Graduate | Tier: 2 | Cycle: 1 | Format: New

B1. Provide Separate Information for the Program Applied for:

Programs Details of The Department

Note: Please provide details of all the programs offered by the department
Note: Please click on Add more before clicking at Save and Next.

Program Level: --Select-- | Name of Department: Computer Science and Engineering

Program Name: --Select--

Year of Start: --Select-- | Sanctioned Intake: --Select-- | Increase / Decrease in Intake (results): --Select--

Year of Increase / Decrease in Intake: --Select-- | Current Intake: --Select-- | Year of AICTE Approval: --Select--

AICTE/Competent Authority Approval Details: --Select-- | Accreditation Status: --Select-- | No. of times program accredited: --Select--

Program Duration (in Years): --Select-- | if program is closed? ☐ | if program is merged? ☐

Add More

Figure No. 4: Sample Page of Pre-Qualifiers (PQS).

4.1.2.3. Submission of 10 % of Total Accreditation Fee

The institution is required to pay 10 per cent of the total applicable accreditation fee (as prompted on the e-NBA portal) (see section 7: Fee Structure and Refund Policy) along with the duly filled-in PQ for further processing of the application. This first-stage fee is non-refundable. The application shall be processed further for only those program(s) whose PQs are approved. If PQs for all the programs submitted through an application are not approved, the application shall not be processed further, and the institution will be informed accordingly.

All the pre-assessment steps mentioned above (Sections 4.1.2.1 to 4.1.2.3) shall be completed within 30 days from the generation of the application. If these steps are not

completed within the stipulated 30 days, the application will need to be regenerated and the PQ need to be filled in again.

4.1.3. Assessment Stage

4.1.3.1. Submission of Self-Assessment Report

Submission of Self-Assessment Report (SAR) and assessment by the visiting team of NBA involves the following steps:

- ❖ Once the PQs are approved, the institution is required to fill-in the e-SAR for the programs whose PQs have been approved, as prompted by the e-NBA portal.
- ❖ To fill in the e-SAR, login to the e-NBA portal, click on "PQ/e-SAR" under "Application", and begin filling in the e-SAR online for each program. The information provided in the PQ (such as student information and faculty details) is pre-filled in the e-SAR, and the institution is required to fill in the remaining information. The e-SAR contains detailed information about the program and enables the institution to conduct a self-assessment against each accreditation criterion. It also provides an opportunity for the institution to present its strengths and weaknesses for evaluation against NBA assessment criteria. However, the e-SAR is expected to be factual rather than narrative.
- ❖ A screenshot of the index page of the e-SAR is provided below as an example in Figure No. 5.

The screenshot displays the e-SAR Index page. At the top, there is a green box containing instructions: "Instructions -", "- For filling SAR please use Mozilla firefox.", "- Charts are acceptable from Microsoft Excel only. - Please put photographs only if it is utmost necessary. The photographs has to be of very low resolution.", "- The content to be entered in the SAR has to be very precise to the specific criteria.", and a link "Instructions to fill SAR.". Below this, the page is organized into sections with orange buttons for navigation:

- Part A: Institutional Information**
 - Institution Details
 - Student & Faculty Details
 - Contact Details
- Part B: Program Information**
 - Program Level Criteria
 - Institute Level Criteria
- Part C: Declaration by the Institution**
 - Declarations
- Annexure I**
 - Program Outcomes

Figure No. 5: Screenshot of e-SAR: Index page.

- ❖ Once all e-SAR of the individual programs are submitted, click on the Final Submit button and pay the remaining 90% of the accreditation fee for all the programs whose e-SARs have been submitted (see section 7.1 – Fee Structure). The institution can view

the submitted e-SARs online and save them as PDF files. The e-SARs submitted online are automatically forwarded to NBA for further necessary action.

- ❖ Once the Self-Assessment Report (e-SAR) is submitted, the Data Capturing Points System (DCS) report is automatically generated based on the information provided by the institution in the e-SAR. The institution must download the DCS report from e-NBA portal and upload it to its official website. Additionally, the institution is required to provide the corresponding link in the e-NBA profile of the institution.

4.1.3.2. Submission of Visit Dates

Post submission of the e-SAR along with the 90% fee and the DCS Report link on its eNBA profile, the institution is allowed to suggest 5 set of dates for the visit and prepare itself for the visit as shown in Figure No. 6. These proposed dates should be during periods when regular classes and all academic activities of the program(s) applied for accreditation are in progress. NBA selects one set of dates and communicates the same to the institution. After receiving the consent from the institution, the visit dates are finalized, and the NBA visiting team conducts the visit.

	Slot 1	Slot 2	Slot 3	Slot 4	Slot 5
From					
To					

Figure No. 6: Propose five sets of dates to visit the institute.

4.1.3.3. Constitution of Visiting Team

- ❖ Once the institution confirms the visit dates, NBA constitutes the visiting team. A typical accreditation visit is of three days' duration. The visiting team consists of a chairperson and two program evaluators for each program.
- ❖ While constituting the visiting team, NBA checks for any conflict of interest. An expert must not be from the same State as the institution and should not have any professional association with the institution and/or the program. Declaration statement is obtained from the chairperson and the evaluators.
- ❖ The complete evaluation process, including the composition of the visiting team, criteria

for nomination, and general policies for team formation, is elaborated in Part II of the general manual, available on the NBA website.

- ❖ The following evaluation documents, which are helpful to the visiting team in preparing for the visit and in guiding them on the processes and procedures to be followed, are available in their respective manuals:
 - Pre-visit evaluation report for the chairperson
 - Pre-visit evaluation report for the program evaluator
 - Visit schedule
 - List of documents to be verified during the visit
 - Evaluation guidelines
 - Chairperson's visit report (Parts A, B, and C)
 - Evaluator's visit report (Parts A, B, and C)
 - Certificate of participation (to be filled in by the Chairperson of the Visiting Team)
 - Certificate and feedback (to be filled in by the Institution).

4.1.3.4. Accreditation Visit

The visiting team will visit the institution seeking accreditation of its program(s) to evaluate and validate the self-assessment of the institution/department as presented in the SAR of the concerned program, in accordance with the specified accreditation criteria. The program evaluators may seek such additional clarifications from the institution as they may deem necessary.

Although it may not be possible to comprehensively describe all the factors to be assessed during the on-site visit, some of the common aspects include the following:

- ❖ Outcomes of the education provided;
- ❖ Quality assurance processes, including internal reviews
- ❖ Assessment processes;
- ❖ Activities and work of students;
- ❖ Entry standards and selection process for admission of students;
- ❖ Motivation and enthusiasm of faculty;
- ❖ Qualifications and professional activities of faculty members;
- ❖ Infrastructure facilities;
- ❖ Laboratory facilities;
- ❖ Library facilities;
- ❖ Industry participation;
- ❖ Organizational structure and governance

In order to assist the visiting team in its assessment, the educational institution should arrange the following:

I. Meetings with:

- ❖ The Head of the Institution/Dean/Heads of Department (HoD)/Program Coordinators.
- ❖ A member of the management (to discuss how the program aligns with the overall strategic direction and focus of the institution, and the management's support for continued funding and development of the program);
- ❖ Faculty members;
- ❖ Alumni (excluding Alma Mater representatives);
- ❖ Students; and
- ❖ Parents.

II. Visit to:

- ❖ Classrooms;
- ❖ Laboratories pertaining to the program;
- ❖ Central and departmental libraries; and
- ❖ Computer centre.

The visiting team conducts an exit meeting with the management representative, the Head of the Institution, the Head of the Department, and other key officials to present its findings, including strengths, concerns, weaknesses, and deficiencies.

The institution will be given an opportunity to withdraw one or more programs from the accreditation process. In such cases, the Head of the Institution must submit the withdrawal request in writing to the chairperson of the visiting team during the exit meeting.

4.1.4. Post-Assessment Stage

4.1.4.1. Processing of Visiting Team Report

Processing of the visiting team report submitted by the visiting team involves the following steps:

- ❖ Once the accreditation visit is completed, the experts prepare the visiting team report and submit it to the NBA.
- ❖ In respect of UG Engineering programs, the visiting team report is first placed before the Moderation Committee. The Moderation Committee examines the visiting team report and identifies borderline cases. The observations of the Moderation Committee for such cases are communicated to the institution, seeking necessary clarification within 10 days of submission of the visiting team report. The response of the institution

is forwarded to the chairperson of the visiting team.

- ❖ The visiting team report, the observations of the Moderation Committee, and the response of the institution are considered by the Evaluation and Accreditation Committee (EAC) in the presence of the chairperson of the visiting team. In the case of programs of all other disciplines, the visiting team reports are considered directly by the respective EACs.
- ❖ The recommendations of the EAC are placed before the concerned Sub-Committee of the Academic Advisory Committee (AAC) for taking a final decision on the accreditation status.

4.1.4.2. Communication of Accreditation Status to Institutions.

The final accreditation status, as decided by the sub-committee of the AAC, is communicated to the institution by the NBA through email as well as by hard copy. The same is available at the NBA Website as well. The Visiting Team report is made available on the respective e-NBA portal for access by the institution. The communication includes:

- ❖ The accreditation status of the program (Six years / Three years / Not Accredited);
- ❖ The validity period of accreditation;
- ❖ The observations and recommendations of the Visiting Team, as approved by the competent authority.

4.1.4.3. Appeal

If the institution is not satisfied with the NBA's decision on the Status of Accreditation, then the institution can make an appeal against the decision within 30 days of date of receipt of communication from NBA along with the fee given in Section 6: Fee Structure and Refund Policy. The appeal is placed before the Appellate Committee in which the institutions are invited to present their case before the Committee. The recommendations of Appellate Committee are considered by the Academic Advisory Committee (AAC) for taking decision on appeal.

PART - V

Assessment Process

5.1. Pre-Visit Activities during Visit

The assessment process plays a significant role in the grant of accreditation to programs of institutions in the country. It begins with the visit of the visiting team, during which the information provided by the institution in the SAR is verified. The visiting team report is then considered by the NBA for taking the final accreditation decision

- i) Once the visiting team is finalized by the NBA, the PQ and SAR are made available to each program evaluator at least 15 days before the on-site visit;
- ii) The program evaluators review the SAR and prepare the pre-visit report well in advance, and send it to the chairperson of the visiting team 2–3 days before the visit. The pre-visit report is discussed on “Day 0” of the visit; and
- iii) Members of the visiting team may contact the NBA, if necessary, for any institutional/program- related details while preparing the pre-visit evaluation report. Under no circumstances should any member of the visiting team contact the institution directly.

5.2. On-Site Visit by Visiting Team

A three-day visit (the complete visit schedule is given in the respective manuals) is conducted by the visiting team constituted by the NBA. The team visits the institution seeking accreditation of its program(s) to evaluate and verify the information/data submitted by the institution in the SAR. The evaluators may obtain clarifications from the institution, as deemed necessary, during the visit. The institution may arrange discussions with stakeholders, visits to central facilities, and provide documentary evidence as needed.

5.2.1. Activities during Visit

The visiting team conducts an accreditation visit to the institution as per the visit schedule provided by the NBA, and the duration of the visit is three days;

- i) The members of the visiting team meet on “Day 0” to review the pre-visit reports and to identify and discuss issues common to all programs. The chairperson briefs the program evaluators on the evaluation process during the visit, followed by a question-and-answer session.
- ii) Each evaluator of respective program submits the day-wise report to chairperson at end of each day;
- iii) The exit meeting is conducted on the last day of the visit and is chaired by the chairperson in the presence of all members of the visiting team. The Management representative / Head of the Institution / Dean / HoD / Program coordinator / Senior faculty members also attend the meeting.

- iv) During the exit meeting, the members of the visiting team share the preliminary findings of the program evaluation. The chairperson provides the institution with an option to withdraw from any of the program(s), if it so wishes, after the findings are shared during the evaluation visit. In case the institution opts to withdraw a program, it shall hand over a written request to the team chairperson during the exit meeting. No communication regarding withdrawal shall be accepted after the visiting team has left the institution;
- v) Each program evaluator submits a complete evaluation report to the chairperson of the visiting team after the exit meeting. The chairperson prepares the executive summary of the visit, consolidates the program-wise evaluation reports, and submits the same to the NBA within 7 days from the date of the exit meeting.

5.3. Verification of Documents, Facilities, and Processes.

The NBA provides the following documents, in print or soft copy, to the visiting team prior to the visit:

- ❖ PQ of each program submitted by the institution for accreditation;
- ❖ SAR of each program applied for accreditation by the institution;
- ❖ Evaluation guidelines;
- ❖ Format of the visit report;
- ❖ Visit schedule;
- ❖ List of documents to be verified during the visit; and
- ❖ Self-declaration and feedback forms for the chairperson and program evaluators

Verification of Documents: The visiting team verifies the authenticity, adequacy, and consistency of the data submitted by the institute in the SAR. Some of the major document verifications are as follows

- ❖ Faculty credentials and appointment orders
- ❖ Student admission, performance, and progression records
- ❖ Curriculum, course files, and assessment documents
- ❖ Financial statements and budget allocations
- ❖ Institutional policies and statutory approvals

Verification of Facilities: The visiting team physically verifies the availability and adequacy of infrastructure, such as:

- ❖ Classrooms, laboratories, workshops, and computing facilities
- ❖ Library resources (books, journals, digital access)
- ❖ Research and innovation facilities
- ❖ Safety measures, accessibility, and maintenance
- ❖ Common facilities like hostels, canteens, and recreational areas (as applicable)

- ❖ Facilities are assessed against NBA norms for quality, relevance, and effective utilization.

Verification of Processes: The visiting team evaluates the effectiveness of academic and administrative processes, including:

- ❖ Teaching–learning and evaluation processes
- ❖ Attainment and assessment of POs and PSOs
- ❖ Continuous improvement mechanisms
- ❖ Governance, leadership, and internal quality assurance practices
- ❖ Industry interaction, internships, and stakeholder feedback systems
- ❖ Interaction with faculty, students, alumni, and management is an integral part of this verification.

5.4. Interaction with Faculty, Students, Alumni, and Employers

The visiting team interacts with various stakeholders to validate the data submitted in the SAR and to assess the effectiveness of academic and administrative processes.

Interaction with Faculty: The visiting team interacts with faculty members to verify:

- ❖ Teaching–learning processes and assessment methods
- ❖ Course delivery, course files, and CO/PO/PSO attainment
- ❖ Faculty qualifications, experience, and workload distribution
- ❖ Research, consultancy, and professional development activities

Interaction with Students: Discussions with student's help the team assess:

- ❖ Learning experiences and academic support systems
- ❖ Awareness of POs/PSOs
- ❖ Availability and utilization of laboratories, library, and other facilities
- ❖ Evaluation processes, mentoring, and grievance redressal mechanisms

Interaction with Alumni: Alumni interactions provide insights into:

- ❖ Program relevance to professional practice and higher studies
- ❖ Skill development and employability outcomes
- ❖ Effectiveness of curriculum and continuous improvement measures
- ❖ Alumni involvement in academic and institutional development

Interaction with Employers: Engagement with employers helps in evaluating:

- ❖ Graduate preparedness for industry requirements
- ❖ Alignment of curriculum with industry needs
- ❖ Professional competencies, ethics, and teamwork skills
- ❖ Feedback mechanisms and industry collaboration initiatives

These interactions enable the visiting team to corroborate documentary evidence with actual practices and assess the overall quality and effectiveness of the program.

5.5. Scores based on Outcomes and Evidence

All claims made in the SAR must be substantiated with authentic documentary and physical evidence. During the on-site visit, the visiting team validates outcome calculations, verifies the supporting evidence, and examines the effectiveness of continuous improvement actions based on outcome analysis. Total scores, or grades are awarded only when outcome attainment is consistently demonstrated and adequately supported by evidence, reflecting the overall quality and effectiveness of the program.

The chairperson of the visiting team will submit the following documents to the NBA:

- i) Visit report of the Chairperson, evaluators' reports, and pre-visit reports of all applied programs, along with student and faculty details for the past three years, including the current academic year.
- ii) Duly filled-in self-declaration forms for the visiting team members including the chairperson;
- iii) Feedback forms duly filled-in by the members of the visiting team, including chairperson.

The visiting team must ensure that no document related to the visit is left with the institution. Upon completion of the accreditation visit, the experts prepare the Visiting Team Report and submit it to the NBA.

PART- VI

Code of Conduct

6. Code of Conduct

6.1. Guidelines for Code of Conduct

The NBA holds its staff and volunteers to the highest standards of conduct. The conflict of Interest policy and code of conduct shall be signed in writing by all individual participating in the NBA accreditation process. The NBA requires ethical conduct from every volunteer and staff member engaged in fulfilling its mission. All individuals are expected to demonstrate professionalism, honesty, integrity, impartiality, fairness, and equity while discharging their responsibilities.

The NBA guidelines for the interpretation of the code of conduct represent the objectives toward which its volunteers and staff members should strive. Personnel involved in accreditation activities can refer to these principles while discharging their responsibilities. NBA volunteers and staff members shall adhere to the following principles:

- a. Accept responsibility for making accreditation decisions and credential evaluations strictly in accordance with approved criteria, in the interest of public safety, health, and welfare, and promptly disclose any factor that may endanger public interest.
- b. Perform services only in areas of their competence. Individuals shall undertake accreditation assignments only when qualified by education and/or experience in the specific technical field involved.
- c. Agree to act as faithful agents or trustees of the NBA, avoiding real or perceived conflicts of interest whenever possible, and disclosing them to the affected parties when they do exist.
- d. Maintain confidentiality of all matters relating to accreditation decisions and credential evaluations, except where disclosure is required by law or where confidentiality may endanger public interest.
- e. Conduct themselves honorably, responsibly, ethically, and lawfully so as to enhance the reputation and effectiveness of NBA.
- f. Treat all persons fairly and without discrimination on the basis of race, religion, gender, disability, age, national origin, marital status, or political affiliation. All individuals involved in accreditation activities shall act with fairness and justice toward all parties.
- g. Assist colleagues and co-workers in their professional development and support them in adhering to this Code of Conduct.
- h. Provide mutual professional support to colleagues and co-workers to ensure compliance with this Code of Conduct.

- i. NBA shall establish mechanisms for prompt and fair adjudication of alleged violations of the Code of Conduct. Individuals found in violation may be subject to one or more sanctions, including ineligibility for participation in future NBA activities.

6.2. Conflict of Interest

Members of the GC, EC, or other Committees of NBA, Program Chairperson, Program Evaluators, Accreditation Consultants, or any staff member should not create situations that may result in Conflicts of Interest or questions regarding the objectivity and credibility of the accreditation process. NBA expects these individuals to behave in a professional and ethical manner, to disclose real or perceived conflicts of interest, and to recuse themselves from discussions or decisions related to real or perceived conflicts of interest. The intent of this policy is to: maintain credibility in the accreditation process and confidence in the decisions of NBA; assure fairness and impartiality in decision-making; disclose real or perceived conflicts of interest; act impartially and avoid the appearance of impropriety.

- a. Individuals representing NBA must not participate in any decision-making capacity, if they have or have had a close, active association with a program or institution that is being considered for official action by NBA.
- b. Individuals must absent themselves from any portion of an NBA meeting in which discussions or decisions occur for which they have a real or perceived Conflict of Interest. Real or perceived conflicts may occur if there is: a close, active association with a program or institution; a financial or personal interest; or any reason that the individual cannot render an unbiased decision.

The names of individuals who have recused themselves during a meeting for conflicts of interest will be recorded.

6.3. Conflict of Interest Policy

6.3.1. Purpose

The intent of this policy is to:

- a. Maintain the credibility of the accreditation process and confidence in NBA's decisions;
- b. Ensure fairness and impartiality in decision-making;
- c. Require disclosure of real or perceived conflicts of interest; and
- d. Avoid any appearance of impropriety.

6.3.2. Persons of Interest who must Declare any Conflict of Interests

This policy applies to all NBA functionaries, including members:

- ❖ Members of the GC and ECE
- ❖ Members of the AAC committee
- ❖ Evaluation and Accreditation Committee members
- ❖ Visiting team members,
- ❖ Resource persons
- ❖ Master trainers,
- ❖ Consultants, and
- ❖ NBA staff.

The responsibility for disclosure of any conflict of interest rests with the individuals concerned. Individuals shall voluntarily disclose the nature of the conflict and recuse themselves from discussions or decisions related to the concerned institution.

6.3.3. Procedure

To avoid potential or perceived conflict of interest, individuals are not to:

- ❖ Have personal or financial interests of any kind in the university/institution under consideration; or
- ❖ Have, or have had, a close or active association with the program/department/school/faculty of the university/institution that is being considered for accreditation. Examples of close or active associations include, but are not limited to:
 - ✓ Serving as faculty or consultant (past or present) to the institution
 - ✓ Being an alumnus or recipient of an honorary degree from the institution.
 - ✓ Holding current or past membership on the governing board or advisory committees of the institution;
 - ✓ Having current or past employment discussions or negotiations with the institution.

The above list is illustrative and not exhaustive. Additional provisions are as follow:

- ❖ Individuals with a conflict of interest must absent themselves from NBA meetings where related discussions or decisions occur.
- ❖ Members of the GC, EC, visiting team, Accreditation Committee, and NBA staff may observe an accreditation visit but shall not serve as members or chairpersons of the visiting teams.
- ❖ All individuals representing NBA must sign a conflict of interest declaration confirming that they have read and understood the policy.

6.3.4. Duty to Disclose

The responsibility of disclosing any conflict of interest lies with the individuals identified as person of interest. They must come forward voluntarily and disclose the nature of their conflict and recuse themselves from discussions about the institution with which they have the said conflict.

6.4. Misconduct by an Institution

NBA holds all higher technical and educational institutions to adhere to the highest standards of conduct. If an institution is found to have indulged in misconduct or willful misrepresentation of data, NBA shall impose appropriate penalties after due verification through inquiry and/or by providing the institution an opportunity for a hearing. The penalties applicable for various misdemeanors are listed in Table No.3.

Table No. 3: List of penalties taken by the NBA.

S. N.	Misdemeanor	Penalty
1.	False or misleading advertisement not conforming to NBA norms in public media.	Notice to withdraw within 7 days, failing which the accreditation shall be withdrawn.
2.	Website information conflicting with SAR.	Notice to correct within 7 days, failing which accreditation shall be withdrawn.
3.	False information in PQ form (clerical/typographical errors)).	Re-submission within 2 weeks.
4.	False information in PQ form (wilful falsification).	Not Eligible for accreditation for 2 years.
5.	False information in SAR not affecting accreditation.	Re-submission within 4 weeks.
6.	False information in SAR affecting accreditation.	Withdrawal of accreditation and/ or ineligibility for 3 years.
7.	Attempts to influence visiting teams or NBA authorities.	Not eligible for accreditation for 2 years.
8	Submission of fabricated or false information to visiting team/NBA	Withdrawal of accreditation and/ or ineligibility for 2 years.
9	Non-cooperation with visiting teams	Not eligible for accreditation for 2 years.

PART - VII

Feedback

7.1. Feedback

Appraisal 360° works by gathering the opinions of multiple people. A series of carefully structured questions prompts an individual to assess skills in several key areas. A number of other people are then asked to provide their perceptions by answering a set of questions, which are compiled into a feedback report. Such feedback is intended to bring transparency and objectivity to the evaluation process, thereby improving the quality of the accreditation process—the shared goal of all stakeholders.

The 360° feedback forms are made available online by NBA for institutions, chairpersons, and program evaluators. The visiting team members shall submit the feedback form by email within three days of the visit, and the institute shall submit the feedback form by email within seven days of the visit. The various forms are as follows:

- A. Feedback form to be filled in by the Head of the Institution:** This form mainly focuses on feedback regarding the entire visiting team comprising the chairperson and program evaluators with respect to the accreditation and evaluation process, and seeks comments with respect to the general behaviour of the visiting team.
- B. Feedback Form to be filled in by the chairperson:** This form mainly focuses on feedback on the performance of the program evaluators and on the co-operation and co-ordination provided by the institution during the accreditation visit.
- C. Feedback form to be filled in by the program evaluators:** This form mainly focuses on feedback on the chairperson and co-evaluators, as well as on the co-operation and co-ordination provided by the institution during the accreditation visit.
- D. Feedback form to be filled in by the chairperson/program evaluators in respect of the service provider:** This form mainly focuses on feedback on the performance of the service provider during the accreditation visit.

PART - VIII

Fee Structure and Refund Policy

8.1. Fee Structure

8.1.1. Registration Fee

The registration fee amount is Rs.1,00,000 only + (Taxes as applicable from time-to-time)

8.1.2. Accreditation Fee

- a. Accreditation fee to be paid by the institution for NBA accreditation for any program, except Diploma (Engineering) programs as shown in Table No. 4.

Table No. 4: With respect to accreditation fees for any program, except Diploma Engineering programs.

No. of Programs to be Accredited	Payment to be made with the application plus taxes as applicable from time-to-time (Amount in Rupees)
1	2,00,000 + Taxes
2	4,00,000 + Taxes
3	6,00,000 + Taxes
4	8,00,000 + Taxes
5	10,00,000 + Taxes

- b. Accreditation fee to be paid by the institutions for NBA accreditation for Diploma Engineering programs, as shown in Table No.5.

Table No. 5: Accreditation fees for NBA accreditation for Diploma Engineering program.

No. of Programs to be Accredited	Payment to be made with the application plus taxes as application plus taxes as applicable (Amount in Rupees)
1	2,00,000 + Taxes
2	3,50,000 + Taxes
3	5,00,000 + Taxes
4	6,50,000 + Taxes
5	8,00,000 + Taxes

8.1.3. Appeal Fee

In the case of an appeal, the institution shall pay Rs.1,50,000/- per program + Taxes as applicable from time-to-time.

8.1.4. Compliance Fee

a. UG Engineering Programs:

Compliance fee to be paid by the institution for NBA accreditation for UG Engineering programs, except Diploma Engineering and UG Pharmacy programs, as shown in Table No.6.

Table No. 6: Compliance fee for UG Engineering programs.

No. of Programs to be Accredited	Payment to be made with the compliance report plus taxes as applicable from time-to-time (Amount in Rupees)
1	2,00,000 + Taxes
2	2,50,000 + Taxes
3	3,00,000 + Taxes
4	3,50,000 + Taxes
5	4,00,000 + Taxes

b. UG Pharmacy and Diploma Engineering Programs:

Compliance fee to be paid by the institution for NBA accreditation for Diploma Engineering and UG Pharmacy programs, are shown in Table No. 7.

Table No. 7: Compliance fee for UG Pharmacy and Diploma Engineering programs.

No. of Programs to be Accredited	Payment to be made with the compliance report plus taxes as applicable from time-to-time (Amount in Rupees)
1	1,00,000 + Taxes
2	1,50,000 + Taxes
3	2,00,000 + Taxes
4	2,50,000 + Taxes
5	3,00,000 + Taxes

8.2. Mode of Payment

The institution may pay the fee (Registration/Accreditation/Appeal) through the following modes:

- I. Net Banking or
- II. Credit/ Debit Card or
- III. NEFT/RTGS as per the details given below:-

A. Bank Name : Canara Bank

- ❖ Branch : M1, South Extension Part 2, Hauz Khas, South Delhi, New Delhi-110049

- ❖ Account Name: National Board of Accreditation
- ❖ Account No. : 0267101523129
- ❖ IFSC Code : CNRB0000267

Or

B. Bank Name : ICICI Bank

- ❖ Branch : ICICI Bank Tower, NBCC Place, Bhisham Pitamah Marg, Pragati Vihar, New Delhi- 110003
- ❖ Account Name: National Board of Accreditation
- ❖ Account No. : 054805000417
- ❖ IFSC Code : ICIC0000548

With regard to the payment through the e-NBA, please indicate GST registration number of your organization.

8.3. Refund Policy

a. Withdrawal of program(s) by the Institution after payment of accreditation Fee but before the constitution of the visiting team

In case an institution requests withdrawal of the program(s) applied for after its application has been approved by NBA for further processing and the fee has been paid, 10% of the accreditation fee per program paid by the institution shall be deducted while refunding the fee, as per the institution's request.

b. Closing/disposing-off the application submitted by the Institution due to Institution not responding to NBA's communication

In case the application is closed after issuance of a final notice to the institution due to failure to submit the PQ/SAR/visit dates even after the prescribed timelines and non-response to the reminders sent by NBA, 20% of the fee paid by the institution shall be deducted at the time of refund.

c. Cancellation/postponement of the visit of the program(s) by the Institution after the visiting team has been constituted

If the institution causes postponement of the visit after the visiting team has been constituted for this purpose, an additional fee of 25% shall be payable before the visit is re-scheduled. If the institution causes cancellation of the visit after the visiting team has been constituted, a cancellation fee of 25% shall be deducted from the fees paid by the institution while refunding fee to the institution.

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